

inspections, crucial for the running of trains. It was agreed that trains would go beyond the border into the other territory till the point where such facilities were available. "Working powers" were also given to Pakistan (and vice versa) for certain sections, which were isolated from the parent railway. These allowed some sections to be operated by the "other Railway". In fact, Jodhpur Railway continued to administer and operate about 513 km of lines in Pakistan until July 1948.

Among some of the biggest problems were the workshops. The key workshops in Lahore and Mughalpura were now with West Pakistan, while Saidpur went to East Pakistan. The governments tried to make special arrangements wherein the workshops across the borders would try to compensate. For instance, Mughalpura would try to fulfil the requirements of the Eastern Punjab Railway, just as the Kanchrapara Workshop in West Bengal, India, would work for the Eastern Bengal Railway within East Pakistan. A similar arrangement was attempted for the Assam Railway with the Saidpur Workshop, but this did not work out.

Lines needed repair as did the rolling stock, but facilities and manpower were limited. Goods that were previously exported through Karachi were rerouted to Bombay, which was ill-equipped to handle the extra load. There was no doubt that there were many problems, some that required urgent attention. All this, however, was nothing compared to the bloodletting that was about to ensue.